



LOBSTER RACE

The Great International Lobster Crate Race is part of the Maine Lobster Festival. Each competitor runs repeatedly along 50 crates strung across Boothbay Harbor. The winner is the one who covers the most crates before falling in.



BOSTON SKYLINE

The largest city in New England, Boston was named after the town of the same name in Lincolnshire, England. Established in 1624, it is the capital and principal port of Massachusetts and a leading center of education, with 35 colleges and universities (including Harvard) in the greater Boston area.

Harvest from the sea

Fishing is a major industry along the northeastern coast, which is particularly famous for shellfish of all kinds. Lobster is the best-known product, but crawfish, crab, and clams are important as well. Clam chowder, a thick, nourishing soup enjoyed all over the world, was invented in Maine.

LOBSTER FISHING

In the state of Maine alone there are nearly 6,000 licensed lobstermen. The trade tends to run in families, with some men “lobstering” exactly the same waters as their fathers and grandfathers before them.

Lobstermen tie colored buoys to their traps so they know where to find them.



1 Setting traps
Lobsters are caught in bait-filled traps. Once they have been lured inside they cannot escape. Most lobstermen check their traps every 3-4 days.



2 All at sea
Each trap (which can weigh as much as a small person when it is full of lobster) is pulled up by hand. The men who do this develop very muscular forearms.



3 Good catch
The smallest commercial lobsters are called “chickens”; the largest are known as “jumbos.”

